

Recall the “veto” experiment, in which subjects were asked to prepare to flex their hands at a certain time, but then **not** flex them at that time.

In that case, the electrical activity in the brain was extremely similar to that observed at RP-onset in the original experiment.

But did subjects in the veto experiment ever decide to flex
their hands?

Suppose that I asked you to prepare to sing the Fight Song in 2 minutes, but not do it. Would you have decided to sing the Fight Song?

Indeed, it seems impossible to decide to do something that you have consciously decided not to do. If I offered you a large reward for deciding, at will, to sing the Fight Song and then not do it, you would not be able to claim the reward.

Is RP-onset an
unconscious
decision?

If RP-onset is an
unconscious
decision, does
that limit our
free will?



replies to
Libet

A large, solid red circle is centered on a white background. Inside the circle, the text "the Libet experiments" is written in a white, sans-serif font, centered both horizontally and vertically.

the Libet
experiments



is free will
an important
good?

Recall the “veto” experiment, in which subjects were asked to

flex then at that time.

prepare to flex their hands at a certain time, but then not

In that case, the electrical activity in the brain was extremely

similar to that derived at RP-set in the original

experiment.

But did subjects in the veto experiment ever decide to flex

their hands?

the Fight Song?

in 2 minutes, but not do it. Would you have decided to sing

Suppose that I asked you to prepare to sing the Fight Song

Indeed, it seems impossible to decide something that

then not do it, you would not be able to claim the reward.

large reward for deciding, at will, to sing the Fight Song and

you have consciously decided not to do. If I offered you a







replies to
Libet

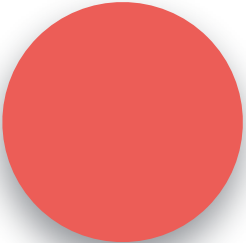
will prosper by contemporary neuroscience.

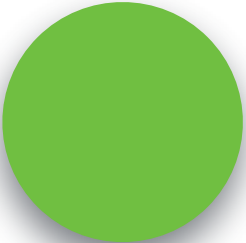
determinism. Our topic today is much more recent challenge to free

the birth of modern physics, many worried about the challenges it would bring from

In ancient times, philosophers worried about the challenge to free will from fate. After







Is RP-onset an
unconscious
decision?

If RP-onset is an
unconscious
decision, does
that limit our
free will?

If RP-onset is an
unconscious
decision, does
that limit our
free will?